SAFAA EL OUAFI.

User Experience Researcher · generative research, research ops, AI

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EXPERIENCE

Decathlon Digital · Senior User Researcher
09/2023 – now

- Built a research system and continuous discovery practice for 5 product teams (atomic repository, rituals, practice roadmap).
- Co-led the AI in Design study: survey, segmentation, interviews, 3-month diary study with 20 users. Turned "buy a tool" into an adoption programme; presented to 300–400 designers.
- Strategic study on how products are prioritised into development (sports leaders, PMOs, PMs).
- Built AI agents for PMs and researchers; founded the community of ~20 UXRs across 4 cities.

Training & volunteering
09/2022 – 09/2023

Data analysis (Le Wagon) and product design.

Alan · Senior User Researcher
09/2021 – 09/2022

Alan Mind: how people in France picture therapy, to make seeking help feel normal. Alan Clinic: adoption and use cases of the medical chat. Alan Clear: buying glasses online.

Algolia · Instructional Designer, then UXR
02/2019 – 09/2021

Algolia Academy and partner certifications; the customer learning journey with Customer Success, from pre-sales to onboarding; learner personas.

Simplon Paris · Programme Manager
09 – 12/2018

Built hiring partnerships (Orange, Microsoft, Capgemini, Accenture, Apple…) so learners left with job contracts.

Next Academy · Kuala Lumpur & Singapore
04 – 08/2018

Programme Manager. Set up the coding bootcamp programmes and improved them from one cohort to the next.

RBK Jordan · Programme Manager
02/2017 – 03/2018

- Coding bootcamp training refugees to become software engineers. Audited and rebuilt the programme; led educators across 3 cohorts of ~30.
- Added English and digital literacy from employer feedback; ran 1:1s, speaking and restorative justice circles.

French Embassy, Amman · Teacher & coordinator
10/2015 – 08/2016

Teacher & instructional designer
09/2008 – 10/2015

Arabic, then French. Learners from age 3 to engineers at Thales. Also founded my own intercultural cooking workshops.

IN ONE LINE

A researcher who builds: systems, rituals and agents, so the user ends up in rooms they weren't invited to.

METHODS

Interviews · diary studies · field shadowing · surveys & data cleaning · usability tests · card sorting · JTBD · segmentation & archetypes · atomic research · research ops · workshops · AI-assisted analysis

TOOLS

Airtable · Notion · Figma · FigJam · Miro · Gemini Gems · Claude · Lovable

LANGUAGES

French, native
English, C2
Arabic, C1
Spanish, B1

EDUCATION

M1, Language didactics & language policy, Université du Maine, 2016
Licence, Arabic (LLCE)
UX research, 2021
Data analysis, Le Wagon, 2022
Product design, 2023

OUTSIDE WORK

Documentary photography · side apps built with AI · cookbook reviews · Chinese & Amazigh